UNIT 3

3.1 Tartary

If I were Lord of Tartary,
  Myself and me alone,
My bed should be of ivory,
  Of beaten gold my throne;
And in my court should peacocks flaunt,
And in my forests tigers haunt,
And in my pools great fishes slant
  Their fins athwart the sun.

The poem has a dreamy quality. Does the picture reflect it? Discuss the picture with the students.

If I were Lord of Tartary,
  Trumpeters every day
To every meal would summon me,
  And in my courtyard bray;
And in the evening lamps would shine,
Yellow as honey, red as wine,
While harp, and flute, and mandoline,
  Made music sweet and gay.

If I were Lord of Tartary,
  I'd wear a robe of beads,
White, and gold, and green they'd be -
  And clustered thick as seeds;
And ere should wane the morning-star,
I'd don my robe and scimitar,
And zebras seven should draw my car
  Through Tartary's dark glades.

Lord of the fruits of Tartary,
  Her rivers silver-pale!
Lord of the hills of Tartary,
  Glen, thicket, wood, and dale!
Her flashing stars, her scented breeze,
Her trembling lake like foamless seas,
Her bird-delighting citron-trees
  In every purple vale!

– *Walter de la Mare*

ENGLISH WORKSHOP

1. Find the words that mean the following from the first stanza.
   - Gold hammered into a flat, thin shape : .....
   - show off proudly : .....
   - tilt, move at an angle : .....
   - across, especially in a slanting direction : .....

2. Find the names of the exotic musical instruments and animals mentioned in the poem.

3. In the last stanza, there are three four-letter words that refer to a beautiful valley.
   They are : • ..... • ..... • .....

4. From the poem, find three lines that use comparisons.
   • ..... • ..... • .....

5. Colour, sound and images from nature add to the beauty of a poem : 'Tartary' is a perfect example of the above. Pick out lines that contain –
   - Colour
   - Sound
   - Images from nature

6. Complete the following phrases with the help of the poem.
   • ..... music • ..... rivers • ..... breeze
   • ..... lake • ..... citron-trees

7. Write about the daily routine of the 'Lord of Tartary' in 8-10 lines.

8. Using your imagination, write about a beautiful region – its land forms, water bodies, flora and fauna, night sky, people, etc.

9. Language Study: **Consonance :** **Consonance** is repetition of one or more consonant sounds especially at the end of words. Consonance is usually pleasant to the ear.
   Examples : • Pitter-patter, pitter-patter
   - Rivers silver-pale
   - The lint was sent with the tent.
   - All's well that ends well.

- Find at least two examples of consonance from poems that you study in this book.